

Beyond Celluloid

Technicolor has its fingers in virtually every visual technology ranging from film production to AAA gaming titles. And when we recently bumped into **Biren Ghose**, Country Head, Technicolor India, we wasted no time firing some quick questions his way. Excerpts from our interview:

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What is Technicolor and what relevance does it have to the world of entertainment?

Technicolor is essentially a company that develops technologies and provides state of the art services to the creative companies. In partnership with these creators, the products of such collaboration which include movies, TV series, DVDs, games, etc., touch people's lives across the globe. Nothing enchants the common man more than the magic of Harry Potter, the thrills of a Superman or Robin Hood, the action of FIFA console games, etc. Embedded in such iconic entertainment is an array of technologies from Technicolor. This includes world-class design, authoring, media production and delivery services, animation and visual effects for motion pictures and television broadcast productions.

What is the scope of your engagement with Bollywood or Indian Cinema as a whole?

Many of the Bollywood/Indian cinema productions have utilized Technicolor's facilities in Hollywood, London, Madrid, Bangkok, Montreal, Spain, Thailand, etc., these include on-location services, post



Biren Ghose, Country Head, Technicolor India

production services, 3D services or Sound post services. In hi-end film productions, creators need a customised workforce for camera/recording/post-production efficiency, etc. Furthermore, Technicolor's leadership in Color Sciences helps in constantly reinventing the "New" look. Several facilities including 3D dailies and on-set playback are part of the company offerings.

Any interesting technology innovation that your company's working on?

Technicolor 3D is a cutting edge proprietary "production to projection" system that leverages 35mm film projectors, in use today by the majority of international theatres, to deliver a high-quality 3D presentation to moviegoers. A patent-pending lens system splits the left and right eye images as the film runs through the projector and delivers a 3D -ready image onto the silver screen. There is a need for showing 3D movies without the high

capital cost of installing digital projection equipment. So Technicolor came out with this short-term alternative to bridge the gap until the theatres can invest in digital.

Watching 3D movies in here is still a pain. Your views?

This year saw a string of 3D releases and there are more releases planned, much to the delight of audiences who have taken to the experience very well. But for experiencing the technology at its best, the theatres also need to be well equipped. Easier said than done, given the fact that showing 3D content is an expensive affair. It entails upgrading of projectors and screens to digital systems. In India, smaller theaters in particular cannot showcase these movies as they are challenged with format choice, investment and the long-term ROI of digital systems. As a better ecosystem for 3D technology builds, it will pave the way for movies with content more suited to 3D technology. This will ensure better and more customised 3D movies and thereby increase interest among the audience. In the US and Western Europe, Technicolor is already making rapid headway in leading the new digital cinema wave. This includes a satellite distribution system which simplifies operations through electronic delivery which seamlessly integrates with the theatre complex.

How's Technicolor associated with animation and gaming?

Technicolor has been part of animation history since 1932, when Disney first used Technicolor's 3-strip color process in the short animated film, *Flowers and Trees*. Technicolor provides state-of-the art 3D, CG animation for TV direct to DVD, commercials, location based films and games. Technicolor is capable of end to end productions from initial design to final completion. Our recent projects include world leading titles for world majors such as DreamWorks, Nickelodeon, Rockstar Games, EA, Square Enix, Sony, Mattel, etc. 